Ex No: 13

Threat Intelligence for SOC

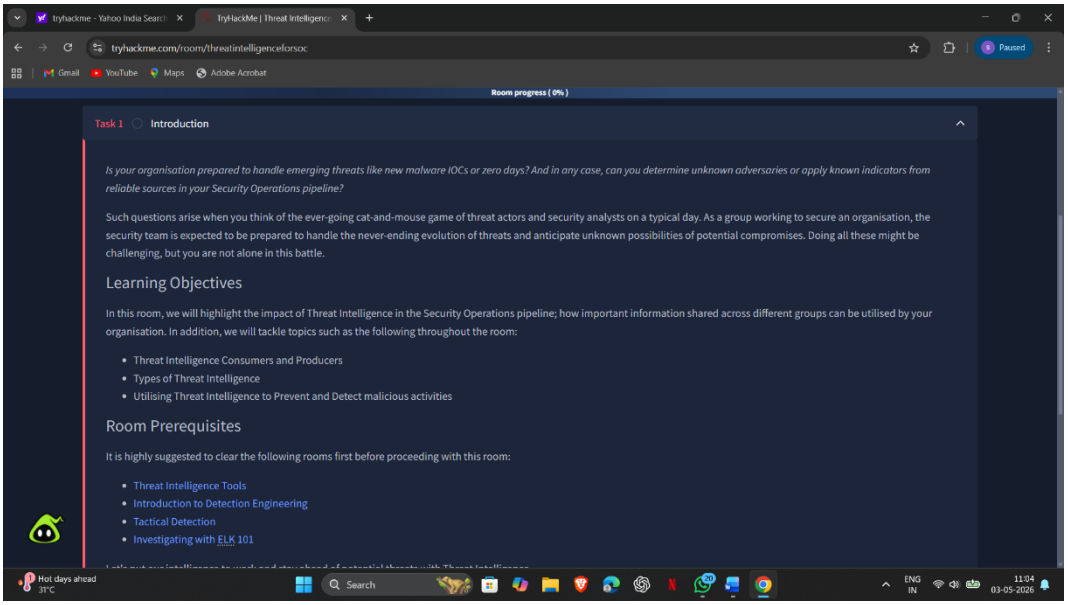
Aim:

To understand and apply threat intelligence in a Security Operations Center (SOC) for identifying, analyzing, and mitigating cyber threats.

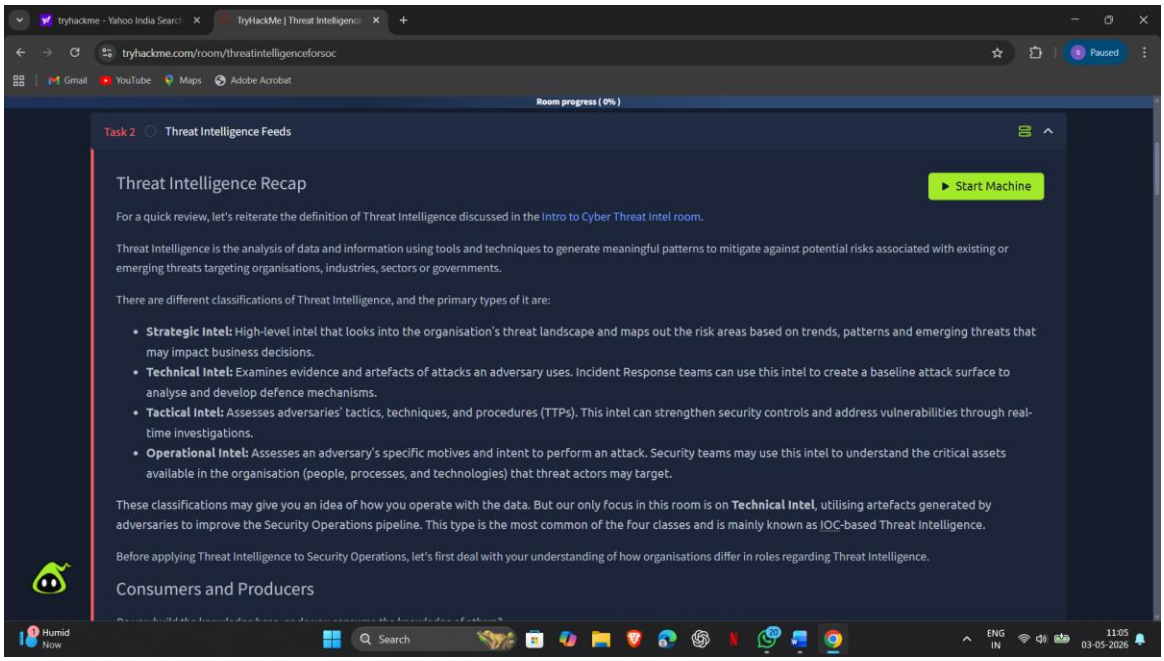
Procedure:

1. Open a web browser and go to TryHackMe, then log in with your account.
2. Search for the room “Threat Intelligence for SOC” and open it.
3. Read the introduction to understand the basics of threat intelligence and its role in a SOC.
4. Start the room by clicking “Start” or launch the machine if required.
5. Go through each task and study the given concepts such as types of threat intelligence, Indicators of Compromise (IoCs), and threat actors.
6. Perform the practical activities provided, like analyzing IPs, domains, or hashes using available tools.
7. Answer all the questions in each task based on your analysis and verify the answers.
8. Take notes of important points and capture screenshots if needed for record submission.
9. Complete all tasks until the room shows 100% completion.
10. Log out from TryHackMe after finishing the experiment.

Task 1: Introduction



Task 2: Threat Intelligence Feeds



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Task 2 Threat Intelligence Feeds

Threat Intelligence Recap

Start Machine

For a quick review, let's reiterate the definition of Threat Intelligence discussed in the Intro to Cyber Threat Intel room.

Threat Intelligence is the analysis of data and information using tools and techniques to generate meaningful patterns to mitigate against potential risks associated with existing or emerging threats targeting organisations, industries, sectors or governments.

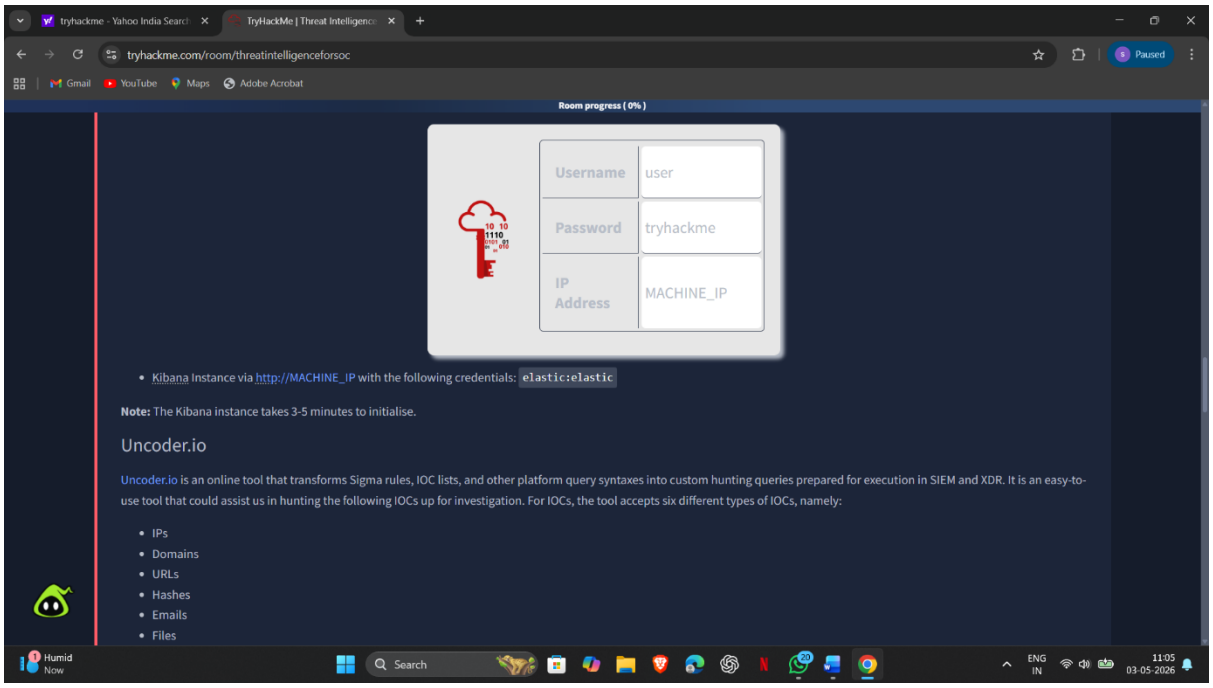
There are different classifications of Threat Intelligence, and the primary types of it are:

- **Strategic Intel:** High-level intel that looks into the organisation's threat landscape and maps out the risk areas based on trends, patterns and emerging threats that may impact business decisions.
- **Technical Intel:** Examines evidence and artefacts of attacks an adversary uses. Incident Response teams can use this intel to create a baseline attack surface to analyse and develop defence mechanisms.
- **Tactical Intel:** Assesses adversaries' tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs). This intel can strengthen security controls and address vulnerabilities through real-time investigations.
- **Operational Intel:** Assesses an adversary's specific motives and intent to perform an attack. Security teams may use this intel to understand the critical assets available in the organisation (people, processes, and technologies) that threat actors may target.

These classifications may give you an idea of how you operate with the data. But our only focus in this room is on **Technical Intel**, utilising artefacts generated by adversaries to improve the Security Operations pipeline. This type is the most common of the four classes and is mainly known as IOC-based Threat Intelligence.

Before applying Threat Intelligence to Security Operations, let's first deal with your understanding of how organisations differ in roles regarding Threat Intelligence.

Consumers and Producers



Room progress (0%)

Username	user
Password	tryhackme
IP Address	MACHINE_IP

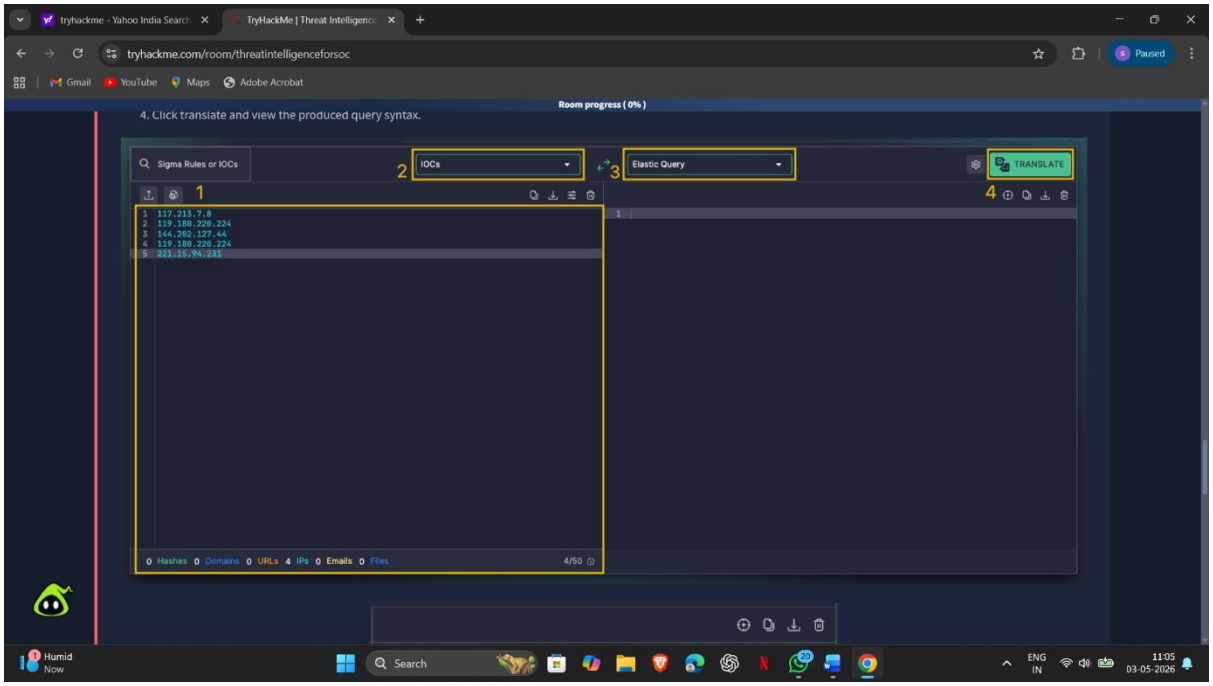
- Kibana Instance via http://MACHINE_IP with the following credentials: `elastic:elastic`

Note: The Kibana instance takes 3-5 minutes to initialise.

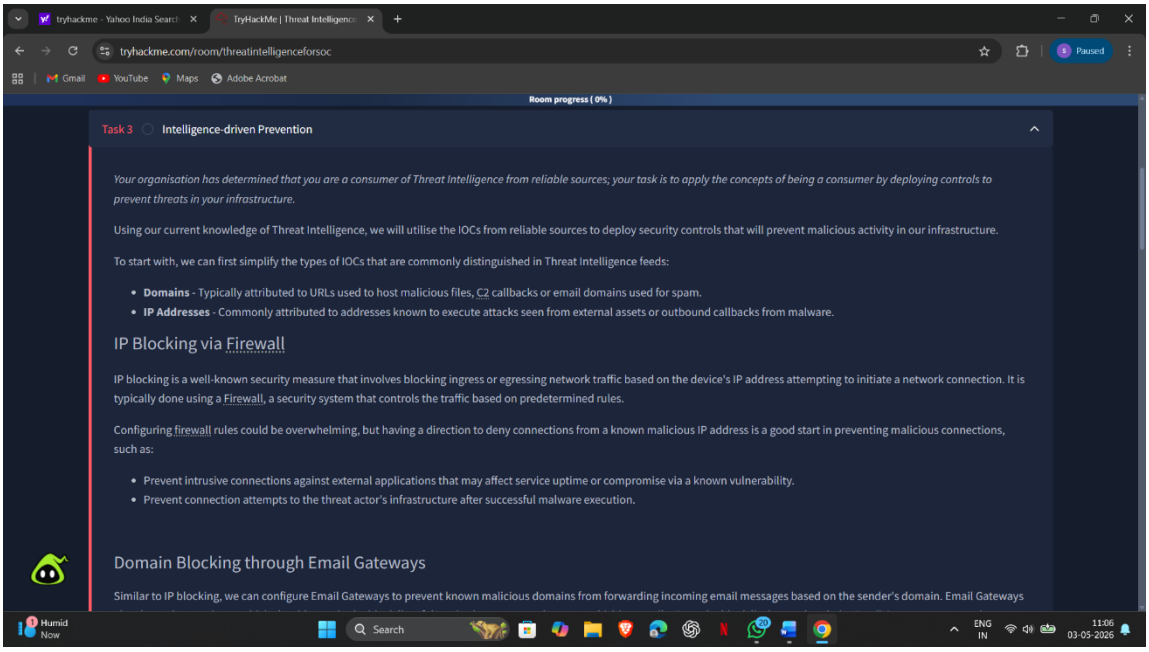
Uncoder.io

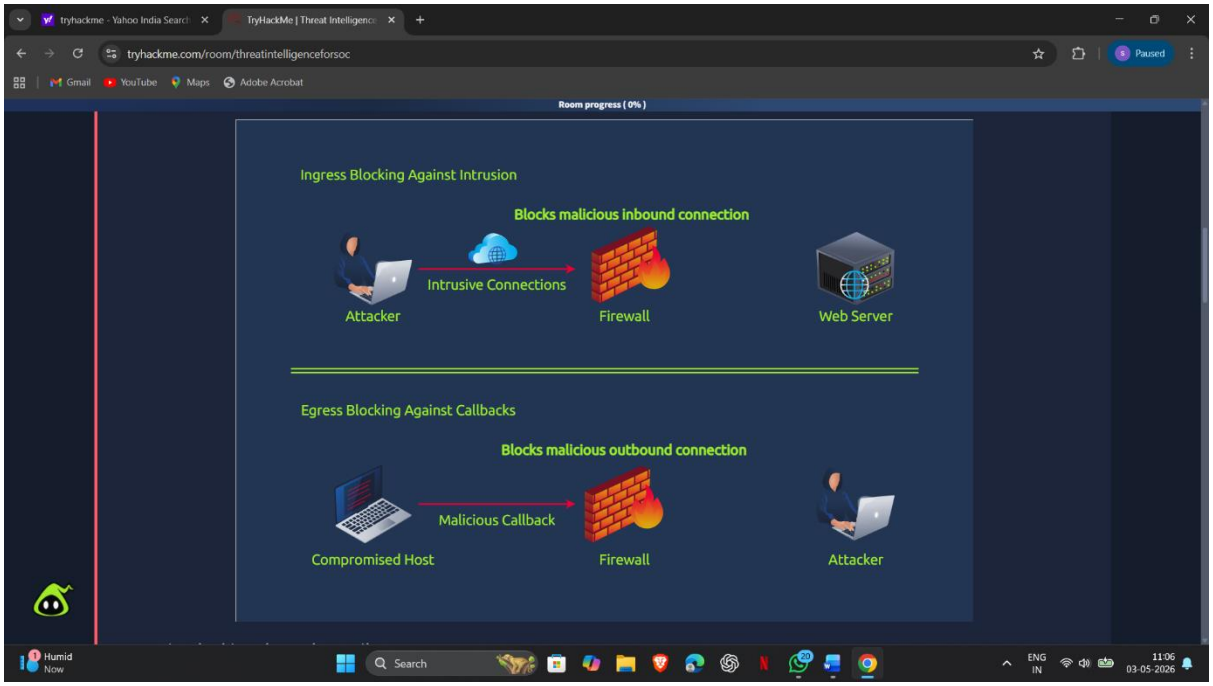
Uncoder.io is an online tool that transforms Sigma rules, IOC lists, and other platform query syntaxes into custom hunting queries prepared for execution in SIEM and XDR. It is an easy-to-use tool that could assist us in hunting the following IOCs up for investigation. For IOCs, the tool accepts six different types of IOCs, namely:

- IPs
- Domains
- URLs
- Hashes
- Emails
- Files



Task 3: Intelligence-Driven Prevention

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Ingress Blocking Against Intrusion
Blocks malicious inbound connection
Attacker
Intrusive Connections
Firewall
Web Server
Egress Blocking Against Callbacks
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Compromised Host
Malicious Callback
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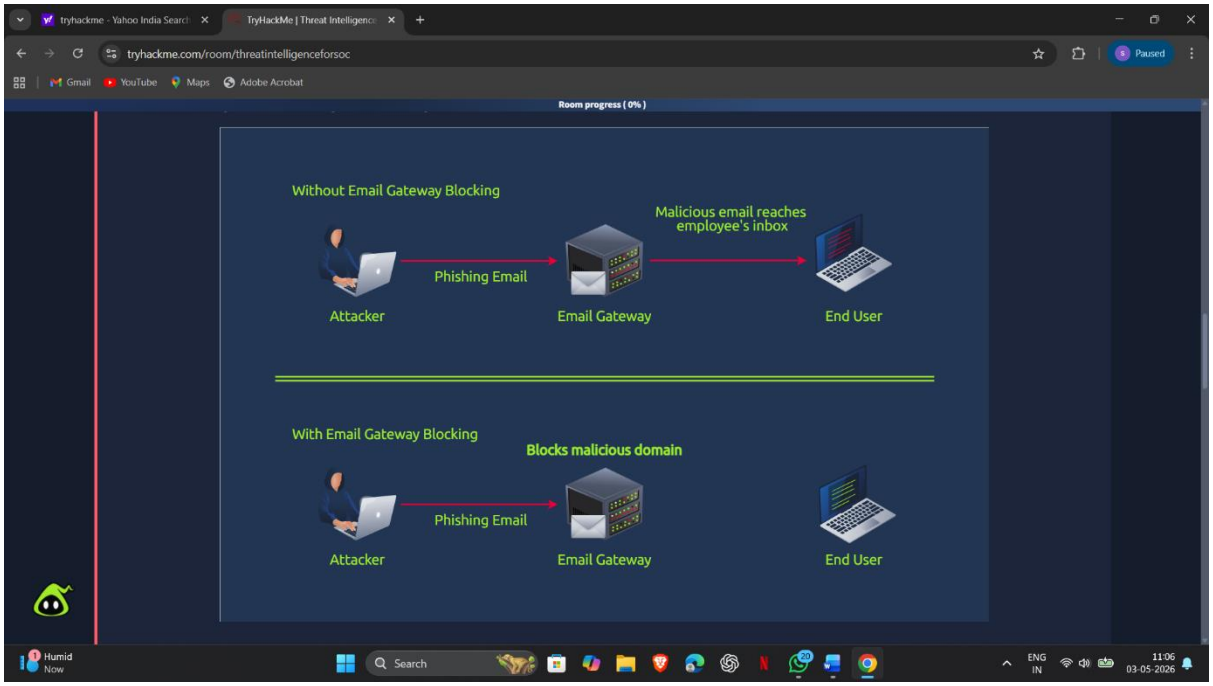
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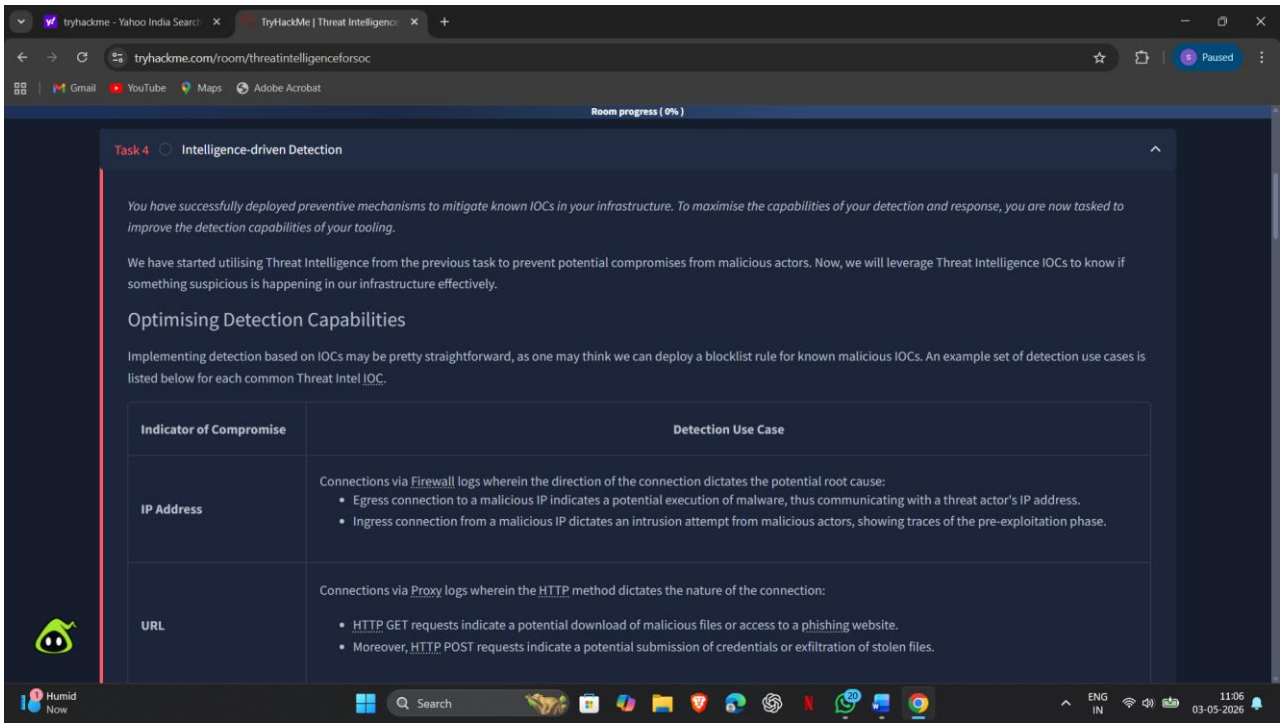
Task 4: Intelligence-driven Detection



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Task 4 Intelligence-driven Detection

You have successfully deployed preventive mechanisms to mitigate known IOCs in your infrastructure. To maximise the capabilities of your detection and response, you are now tasked to improve the detection capabilities of your tooling.

We have started utilising Threat Intelligence from the previous task to prevent potential compromises from malicious actors. Now, we will leverage Threat Intelligence IOCs to know if something suspicious is happening in our infrastructure effectively.

Optimising Detection Capabilities

Implementing detection based on IOCs may be pretty straightforward, as one may think we can deploy a blocklist rule for known malicious IOCs. An example set of detection use cases is listed below for each common Threat Intel IOC.

Indicator of Compromise	Detection Use Case
IP Address	Connections via Firewall logs wherein the direction of the connection dictates the potential root cause: • Egress connection to a malicious IP indicates a potential execution of malware, thus communicating with a threat actor's IP address. • Ingress connection from a malicious IP dictates an intrusion attempt from malicious actors, showing traces of the pre-exploitation phase.
URL	Connections via Proxy logs wherein the HTTP method dictates the nature of the connection: • HTTP GET requests indicate a potential download of malicious files or access to a phishing website. • Moreover, HTTP POST requests indicate a potential submission of credentials or exfiltration of stolen files.

Result:

Successfully understood and applied threat intelligence concepts in a SOC environment. Identified and analyzed Indicators of Compromise (IoCs), studied threat actors and attack patterns, and utilized threat intelligence techniques to improve detection and response to cyber threats.